

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Can I see your references, please?



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can offer advice and solutions about jobs and work.
- I can talk about causes and effects.
- I can talk about what is advisable.

Ask your partner:

- Who would you like to work with? Why?
- Who would you give a good reference to? Why?



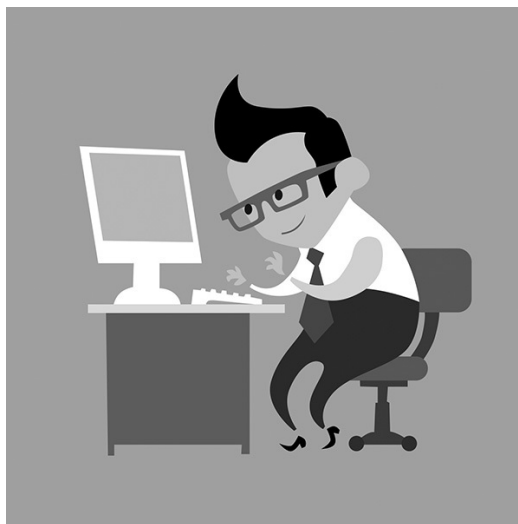


Let's Explore!

The editors of *Cambridge Life* received a **letter of recommendation**** for Angela Weston. Mr. Toberman is a good **reference*****!

* A "letter of recommendation" helps you get a job. It talks about your qualities and work experience.

** A "reference" is a person who talks or writes about you as a good employee.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

To Whom It May Concern:

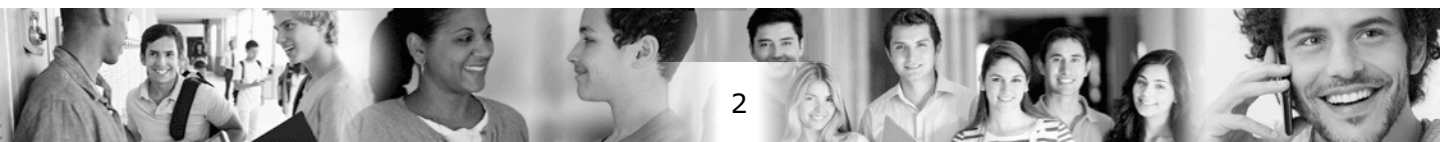
It is my pleasure to write this letter of recommendation for Ms. Angela Weston. Ms. Weston has worked over the past two years as an event coordinator and liaison officer at the Cambridge Community Center. She is a motivated and responsible young woman. If you offer her a position as a journalist, I am certain that she will prove to be a positive addition to your institution.

You may want to learn more about her background in communications. You could take a look at her portfolio. It is very impressive! You should ask her questions about world events. You will see that she is very intelligent and knowledgeable. Are you looking for someone who can multitask? You should definitely consider her résumé.

Ms. Weston will take the initiative to identify problems and devise solutions if she has the opportunity. It would be a good idea to let her cover business news. You might want to encourage her in this direction.

If you require any further information about Ms. Weston, I suggest you contact me directly.

Sincerely,
Albert Toberman





Let's Practice!

What does Mr. Toberman advise*?

*"To advise" is a verb. Advise is a noun.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. learn / want / background / in / to / more / communications. / about / may / You / her

2. business / news. / would / cover / a / It / her / let / be / idea / to / good

3. encourage / her / this / may / to / want / in / direction. / You

4. you / information / contact / you / directly. / suggest / me / about / require / any / If / further / I / Ms. / Weston



Let's Practice!

How does Mr. Toberman talk about cause and effect in his letter?

Instructions: Use the phrases from the box to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

institution / she will prove / offer her a position /
will take the initiative / journalist / has the
opportunity / positive addition / identify
problems and devise solutions

- 1) If you _____ as a _____, I am certain that _____ to be a
_____ to your _____.
- 2) Ms. Weston _____ to _____ if she _____.





Extension Activity

Role-play a situation helping an employer choose a good employee.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose 3 celebrities. They can be actors, sports personalities, politicians, etc.
- Write the names of the celebrities and find their image, if possible.
- Choose a position your company needs to fill, like accountant, police officer, banker, etc.
- You work in the Human Resources department of a company. Your partner is the boss. Explain why they should choose one person.
- Explain why they should not choose the other people.
- Use conditional sentences with *If*-clauses.
- Talk about what is advisable.
- Your partner makes a decision and explains the decision.
- Change roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about jobs and work.

☐
☐

I use conditional sentences related to hiring an employee.

☐
☐

I say what is advisable.

☐
☐

I explain a decision.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **to whom it may concern** (expression): used at the start of a formal letter if you do not know who is going to read it
e.g. To Whom It May Concern: It is my pleasure to write this letter of recommendation for Ms. Angela Weston.
- **event coordinator** (noun): person whose job is to organize large events
e.g. Ms. Weston has worked over the past two years as an event coordinator.
- **liaison officer** (noun): person whose job is to put people or groups in contact with each other
e.g. She has also been a liaison officer.
- **to devise** (verb): to think of
e.g. Ms. Weston will take the initiative to identify problems and devise solutions.
- **background** (noun): education and work experience
e.g. She has a solid background in communications.
- **knowledgeable** (adjective): knowing a lot of things about one or more topics
e.g. You will see that she is very intelligent and knowledgeable.
- **to multitask** (verb): to do more than one thing at the same time
e.g. Are you looking for someone who can multitask?





Learning Points

How to Deal with Problems + Offering Advice and Solutions

When you want to offer advice or give solutions to a problem, you use modals like *might*, *should* or *could*.

These modals can go at the beginning of the sentence, or after a clause starting with "If ...".

The modal is followed by a verb in the base form. You do not use "to".

I would/I'd ...

I wouldn't ...

You could ...

You should ...

Examples:

- *You could take a look at her online portfolio. It is very impressive!*
- *You should ask her questions about world events.*





Learning Points

Conditional Sentences with *If*-Clauses

You use conditional sentences with *If*-clauses to talk about real possibilities in the future.

You use the First Conditional to say it's possible that you will do something. In that condition, something else may, will or will not happen.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *If*-clause and the *condition* clause.

The *If*-clause can go at the start or the end of the sentence.

When the *If*-clause starts a sentence, you separate the two clauses with a comma. When the main clause starts the sentence, you do not use a comma.

1st Clause	2nd Clause	Meaning
If you offer her a position as a journalist,	I am certain that she will prove to be a positive addition to your institution.	It's possible you offer her a position. In this condition: she will prove to be a positive addition.
Ms. Weston will take the initiative to identify problems and devise solutions	if she has the opportunity.	It's possible Ms. Weston has the opportunity. In this condition: she will take the initiative to identify problems and devise solutions.

Examples:

- *If you offer her a position as a journalist, I am certain that she will prove to be a positive addition to your institution.*
- *Ms. Weston will take the initiative to identify problems and devise solutions if she has the opportunity.*

